ENGLISH C2 · ADVANCED GRAMMAR

Existential and presentational structures

Use there-constructions and presentational clauses to introduce entities, events and discourse developments with controlled agreement and focus. The lesson connects form, meaning, register and real editorial decisions rather than treating the pattern as an isolated rule.

THE CENTRAL IDEA

Use existential and presentational structures to delay a new or heavy notional subject until the reader has a presentational frame while preserving the intended meaning and register.

Use there-constructions and presentational clauses to introduce entities, events and discourse developments with controlled agreement and focus.

MODEL

There remains a substantial gap between policy and practice.

there + be/seem/arise/remain + notional subject

6 GUIDED STAGES · 30 LEARNING DECISIONS

This complete guide combines explanation, visual reasoning, practice and feedback. Separate exercise and answer-key editions are also available from the lesson page.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

OUTCOME 1

01

Recognise the main existential and presentational structures patterns in authentic contexts.

OUTCOME 2

02

Choose a form that accurately expresses delay a new or heavy notional subject until the reader has a presentational frame.

OUTCOME 3

03

Avoid errors that change time, agency, emphasis or speaker commitment.

OUTCOME 4

04

Use the structure appropriately in formal description, narrative, academic exposition and announcements.

Build meaning before form

Use there-constructions and presentational clauses to introduce entities, events and discourse developments with controlled agreement and focus.

What existential and presentational structures communicates

Use there-constructions and presentational clauses to introduce entities, events and discourse developments with controlled agreement and focus.

The central purpose is to delay a new or heavy notional subject until the reader has a presentational frame. A successful choice therefore preserves the proposition while making the intended relationship, viewpoint or degree of commitment visible to the reader.

There remains a substantial gap between policy and practice.	a new entity introduced as existing or persisting
There then emerged a second, less predictable pattern.	a development introduced as new to the discourse
There appears to be little support for the stronger claim.	a cautiously inferred state introduced in end focus

How the pattern is built

Use this working formula: there + be/seem/arise/remain + notional subject. The formula is a decision path: it identifies the trigger, the clause architecture and the element that carries tense or modality.

The model “There remains a substantial gap between policy and practice.” shows the complete pattern in context. Rebuild the sentence from meaning to form instead of translating each word independently.

Choice	Structure	Example
Existential state	there + be/remain + noun phrase	There remains a substantial gap between policy and practice.
Emergent event	there + arise/emerge/follow + noun phrase	There then emerged a second, less predictable pattern.
Complex existential	there + appear/seem + to be + noun phrase	There appears to be little support for the stronger claim.

Choose by meaning, not by surface similarity

Neighbouring structures may contain similar words but perform different jobs. Compare the three reference patterns and name the intended effect before completing the sentence.

A reliable answer explains both why the chosen form works and why a plausible alternative would change the meaning, time relation, information focus or level of certainty.

Meaning	Best route
a new entity introduced as existing or persisting	Existential state
a development introduced as new to the discourse	Emergent event
a cautiously inferred state introduced in end focus	Complex existential

Register, discourse and editorial control

This grammar is especially useful in formal description, narrative, academic exposition and announcements. Its value comes from helping the reader process a relationship efficiently, not from making the sentence sound artificially complex.

After editing, check recoverability, natural word order and consistency with the surrounding paragraph. If the marked structure creates ambiguity, return to a fuller or more neutral clause.

Reason through the pattern

The visual map moves from communicative purpose to structural trigger, then to the final clause. It keeps meaning and form visible at the same time so the learner can justify every choice.

01	02	03
there	be/seem/arise/remain	notional subject

DECIDE IN THIS ORDER

STEP 1

Decision 1

Identify the communicative purpose before selecting a form: delay a new or heavy notional subject until the reader has a presentational frame.

STEP 2

Decision 2

Locate the structural trigger and match it to one of the reference patterns.

STEP 3

Decision 3

Check time reference, clause relationships, agency and speaker commitment.

STEP 4

Decision 4

Read the complete sentence in context and confirm that its register suits formal description, narrative, academic exposition and announcements.

STEP 5

Decision 5

Compare the result with a neutral alternative and keep the marked form only when it adds useful meaning.

Compare forms and meanings

Use the table to justify each structural choice.

Pattern	Form	Model
Existential state	there + be/remain + noun phrase	There remains a substantial gap between policy and practice.
Emergent event	there + arise/emerge/follow + noun phrase	There then emerged a second, less predictable pattern.
Complex existential	there + appear/seem + to be + noun phrase	There appears to be little support for the stronger claim.

EXAMPLES AT A GLANCE

There remains a substantial gap between policy and practice.	a new entity introduced as existing or persisting
There then emerged a second, less predictable pattern.	a development introduced as new to the discourse
There appears to be little support for the stronger claim.	a cautiously inferred state introduced in end focus

COMMON ERRORS

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Match agreement carefully when the notional subject is complex or coordinated.

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Do not use presentational there with verbs that do not license the construction.

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Do not treat there as a referential location pronoun in this construction.

Recognition in context

Choose the sentence whose grammar matches the stated communicative purpose.

A1 · MEANING DECISION 1

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: a new entity introduced as existing or persisting?

OPTIONS There remains a substantial gap between policy and practice. · There then emerged a second, less predictable pattern. · There appears to be little support for the stronger claim.

A2 · MEANING DECISION 2

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: a development introduced as new to the discourse?

OPTIONS There then emerged a second, less predictable pattern. · There appears to be little support for the stronger claim. · There remains a substantial gap between policy and practice.

A3 · MEANING DECISION 3

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: a cautiously inferred state introduced in end focus?

OPTIONS There appears to be little support for the stronger claim. · There remains a substantial gap between policy and practice. · There then emerged a second, less predictable pattern.

A4 · INTERPRETATION 4

What does “There remains a substantial gap between policy and practice.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS a new entity introduced as existing or persisting · a development introduced as new to the discourse · a cautiously inferred state introduced in end focus

A5 · INTERPRETATION 5

What does “There then emerged a second, less predictable pattern.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS a development introduced as new to the discourse · a cautiously inferred state introduced in end focus · a new entity introduced as existing or persisting

A6 · INTERPRETATION 6

What does “There appears to be little support for the stronger claim.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS a cautiously inferred state introduced in end focus · a new entity introduced as existing or persisting · a development introduced as new to the discourse

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Form and function

Identify both the structural family and the meaning carried by each model.

B1 · FORM AND FUNCTION 1

“There remains a substantial gap between policy and practice.” uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Existential state / Emergent event / Complex existential · Gap 2: a new entity introduced as existing or persisting / a development introduced as new to the discourse / a cautiously inferred state introduced in end focus

B2 · FORM AND FUNCTION 2

“There then emerged a second, less predictable pattern.” uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Emergent event / Complex existential / Existential state · Gap 2: a development introduced as new to the discourse / a cautiously inferred state introduced in end focus / a new entity introduced as existing or persisting

B3 · FORM AND FUNCTION 3

“There appears to be little support for the stronger claim.” uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Complex existential / Existential state / Emergent event · Gap 2: a cautiously inferred state introduced in end focus / a new entity introduced as existing or persisting / a development introduced as new to the discourse

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

03 · PRACTICE STAGE

Guided discourse choices

Maintain accurate form and meaning across a connected sequence of decisions.

C1 · EDITORIAL PLANNING

Choose the model that expresses a new entity introduced as existing or persisting: _____. Choose the model that expresses a development introduced as new to the discourse: _____. Choose the model that expresses a cautiously inferred state introduced in end focus: _____. Choose the model built with there + be/remain + noun phrase: _____. Choose the model built with there + arise/emerge/follow + noun phrase: _____. Choose the model built with there + appear/seem + to be + noun phrase: _____.

_____
_____

WORD BANK

Available forms

There appears to be little support for the stronger claim. · There remains a substantial gap between policy and practice. · There then emerged a second, less predictable pattern.

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Open reconstruction

Recover the missing structural trigger without a word bank.

D1 · INDEPENDENT RECONSTRUCTION

_____ a substantial gap between policy and practice. _____ a second, less predictable pattern. _____ little support for the stronger claim. State the full structural pattern for Existential state: _____. State the full structural pattern for Emergent event: _____.

_____
_____
_____
_____

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Controlled transformation

Rewrite the neutral source so that it performs the requested advanced function.

E1 · TRANSFORMATION 1

Rewrite “A substantial gap still exists.” using the Existential state pattern to express a new entity introduced as existing or persisting.

_____
_____

E2 · TRANSFORMATION 2

Rewrite “A second pattern then emerged.” using the Emergent event pattern to express a development introduced as new to the discourse.

_____
_____

E3 · TRANSFORMATION 3

Rewrite “Little support appears to exist.” using the Complex existential pattern to express a cautiously inferred state introduced in end focus.

_____
_____

E4 · TRANSFORMATION 4

Rewrite “A substantial gap still exists.” using the Existential state pattern to express a new entity introduced as existing or persisting.

_____
_____

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Communicative production

Use the grammar independently in realistic academic, professional and conversational contexts.

F1 · PRODUCTION TASK 1

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Existential state to express a new entity introduced as existing or persisting, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

F2 · PRODUCTION TASK 2

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Emergent event to express a development introduced as new to the discourse, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

F3 · PRODUCTION TASK 3

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Complex existential to express a cautiously inferred state introduced in end focus, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

Final self-check

Complete these prompts without reopening the guide.

R1 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: communicative purpose.

_____
_____
_____

R2 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: structural trigger.

_____
_____
_____

R3 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: meaning contrast.

_____
_____
_____

R4 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: register choice.

_____
_____
_____

Recognition in context

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

A1

There remains a substantial gap between policy and practice.

Existential state is the best match because a new entity introduced as existing or persisting.

A2

There then emerged a second, less predictable pattern.

Emergent event is the best match because a development introduced as new to the discourse.

A3

There appears to be little support for the stronger claim.

Complex existential is the best match because a cautiously inferred state introduced in end focus.

A4

a new entity introduced as existing or persisting

The Existential state pattern communicates a new entity introduced as existing or persisting.

A5

a development introduced as new to the discourse

The Emergent event pattern communicates a development introduced as new to the discourse.

A6

a cautiously inferred state introduced in end focus

The Complex existential pattern communicates a cautiously inferred state introduced in end focus.

Form and function

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

B1

Existential state / a new entity introduced as existing or persisting

The structure belongs to the Existential state pattern. Its communicative purpose is a new entity introduced as existing or persisting.

B2

Emergent event / a development introduced as new to the discourse

The structure belongs to the Emergent event pattern. Its communicative purpose is a development introduced as new to the discourse.

B3

Complex existential / a cautiously inferred state introduced in end focus

The structure belongs to the Complex existential pattern. Its communicative purpose is a cautiously inferred state introduced in end focus.

Guided discourse choices

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

C1

There remains a substantial gap between policy and practice.

Existential state: there + be/remain + noun phrase.

C2

There then emerged a second, less predictable pattern.

Emergent event: there + arise/emerge/follow + noun phrase.

C3

There appears to be little support for the stronger claim.

Complex existential: there + appear/seem + to be + noun phrase.

C4

There remains a substantial gap between policy and practice.

Existential state: there + be/remain + noun phrase.

C5

There then emerged a second, less predictable pattern.

Emergent event: there + arise/emerge/follow + noun phrase.

C6

There appears to be little support for the stronger claim.

Complex existential: there + appear/seem + to be + noun phrase.

Open reconstruction

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

D1

There remains

Existential state requires “There remains” in this model. there + be/remain + noun phrase.

D2

There then emerged

Emergent event requires “There then emerged” in this model. there + arise/emerge/follow + noun phrase.

D3

There appears to be

Complex existential requires “There appears to be” in this model. there + appear/seem + to be + noun phrase.

D4

there + be/remain + noun phrase

Existential state is built as there + be/remain + noun phrase.

D5

there + arise/emerge/follow + noun phrase

Emergent event is built as there + arise/emerge/follow + noun phrase.

Controlled transformation

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

E1

There remains a substantial gap between policy and practice.

there + be/remain + noun phrase. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended existential state effect.

E2

There then emerged a second, less predictable pattern.

there + arise/emerge/follow + noun phrase. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended emergent event effect.

E3

There appears to be little support for the stronger claim.

there + appear/seem + to be + noun phrase. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended complex existential effect.

E4

There remains a substantial gap between policy and practice.

there + be/remain + noun phrase. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended existential state effect.

Communicative production

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

F1

There remains a substantial gap between policy and practice. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses there + be/remain + noun phrase accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

F2

There then emerged a second, less predictable pattern. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses there + arise/emerge/follow + noun phrase accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

F3

There appears to be little support for the stronger claim. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses there + appear/seem + to be + noun phrase accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

Diagnose the pattern, not only the score

Use this page to decide what to revisit in the complete guide.

CHECK · TRIGGER OR CONTEXT

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · AUXILIARY OR STRUCTURAL CHOICE

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · MAIN VERB OR CLAUSE FORM

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · MEANING AND REGISTER

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____